HITTER EVALUATION · R&D ADVANCE REPORT

Juan Soto

NYM · Bats L · Age 27 · 1,929 pitches seen · 111 G

Hitter evaluation
2026 regular season
Data through **2026-09-27**
MLBAM 665742

PA	AVG/OBP/SLG	WOBA	XWOBA	WRC+	HR	K%	BB%	BARREL%	HARD-HIT%	AVG / MAX EV	SPD (FG)
482	.275/.393/.515	.385	.411	147	27	13.5%	16.2%	13.9%	48.1%	92.2 / 114.2	4.0

BOTTOM LINE

1. **Plus-plus swing decisions (70):** 19.7% chase (97th pct), 63% zone swing, 16.2% BB.
2. **Punishes sweepers:** RV/100 +4.9 (league +0.0), .510 xwOBA on contact (n=149) — avoid in the zone.
3. **Plus hit tool (65):** 81% contact, xBA .295, 13.5% K.
4. **Plus power (65):** 13.9% barrels/BBE (92nd pct), EV90 106.8 mph, max 114.2, ISO .240.
5. **Platoon split — weaker vs LHP:** .344 wOBA vs LHP, .405 vs RHP (60 pts; xwOBA .360 / .441; 165 / 300 PA) — a matchup lever late in games.

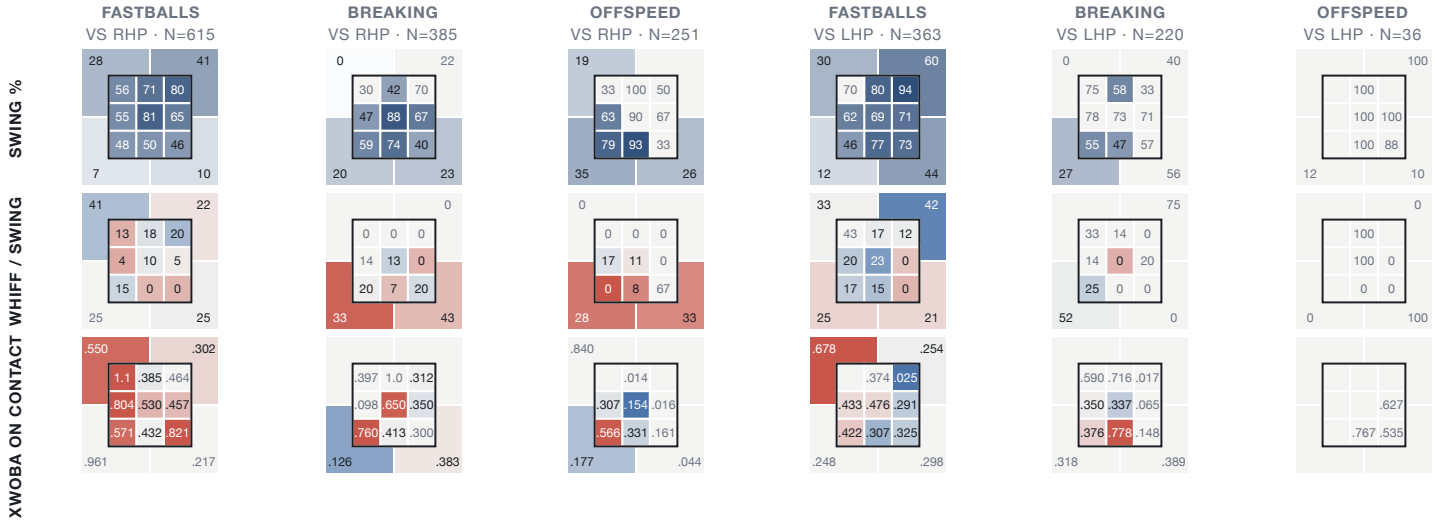
20–80 GRADES

vs 310 hitters ≥1,000 pitches

Hit	65	Contact 81%
Power	65	Barrel 13.9%
Discipline	70	Chase 20%
Pull-air	50	18% of BBE
Speed (Spd)	50	Spd 4.0
vs pitch group	65 FB +1.6	75 BRK +2.6	55 OFF +1.0

ZONES Swing decisions & damage — damage on offspeed down & away vs RHP (.566 xwOBAcon); misses fastballs chase up & in vs LHP (42% whiff vs 24% league)

Catcher's view, 13 zones (3×3 strike zone + 4 chase quadrants); hitter-relative, so 'in' flips by side. Swing%: darker = swings more (frequency, not quality). Whiff and xwOBA on contact are tinted vs the league rate in the same zone and pitch group (red = better for the hitter). Grey = small sample (<12 pitches, <8 swings, <5 balls in play).



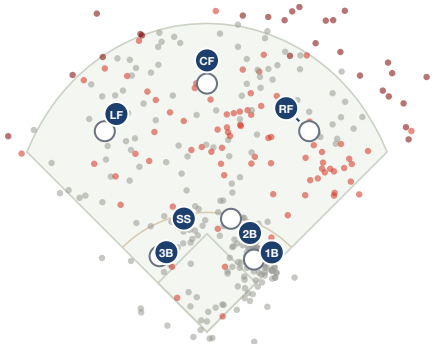
PITCH TYPES Pitch types — best vs sweeper (+4.9 RV/100), worst vs splitter (-1.7)

All pitches seen, both hands. RV/100 = hitter run value per 100 pitches (+ = good for him); Lg = league average for the band. Tints vs league band rates; grey rows n < 80. FF bands overlap (velo and ride).

PITCH / BAND	N	SWING	WHIFF	CHASE	XWOBACON	XWOBA	RV/100	LG
FF 96+ mph	181	46%	26%	29%	.686	.469	+2.5	-0.4
FF 93–95.9	163	49%	21%	24%	.450	.429	+0.4	+0.0
FF < 93	93	43%	5%	17%	.448	.451	+4.3	+0.6
FF ride ≥ 18 in	104	46%	15%	28%	.464	.372	+2.5	-0.8
Sinker	415	43%	15%	22%	.429	.425	+0.7	-0.3
Cutter	126	36%	18%	16%	.380	.413	+3.1	+0.1
Slider	271	33%	20%	17%	.398	.398	+0.9	-0.0
Sweeper	149	39%	22%	19%	.510	.449	+4.9	+0.0
Curveball	185	32%	25%	18%	.404	.371	+3.3	+0.3
Changeup	199	44%	14%	27%	.400	.385	+2.1	+0.1
Splitter	88	42%	24%	16%	.248	.299	-1.7	-0.1

SPRAY Spray — 49% pulled; shift-legal alignment adds +2.1 outs/100 BIP (cross-validated)

All balls in play (grey out, red hit, dark red HR). Hollow = standard alignment, navy = optimized (2 IF each side of 2B, IF on dirt).



BIP MIX	PULL	CENT	OPPO	PULL-AIR	GB	LD	FB	PU
Soto n=337	**49%**	**31%**	**20%**	**18%**	**39%**	**19%**	**33%**	**9%**
League	45%	28%	27%	17%	42%	24%	27%	7%

Alignment: +2.1 outs per 100 BIP vs standard, cross-validated (+9.5 in-sample; n=337 BIP batting L). RF 8° toward opposite side, 16 ft deeper; 2B 12° toward pull side, 10 ft shallower; CF 0° toward pull side, 30 ft deeper.

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ATTACK How to attack — finish with curveball down & away vs RHP

Model-preferred pitch (lowest expected xwOBA vs this hitter from a league-average arsenal) and its best location, by count bucket and pitcher hand; second-best and the pitch to avoid with expected xwOBA. Grey line = his actual results on that pitch group in that zone.

COUNT	VS RHP			VS LHP		
Even 0-0, 1-1, 2-2	**Curveball** → Down & away his breaking there: 20% whiff · .760 xwOBAcon · n=17	.287 2nd ST .290	avoid **SI** .307	**Curveball** → Down & away his breaking there: 25% whiff · .376 xwOBAcon · n=22	.269 2nd ST .270	avoid **SI** .300
Ahead 0-1, 0-2, 1-2	**Four-seam** → Down & away his fastballs there: 15% whiff · .571 xwOBAcon · n=27	.312 2nd CU .314	avoid **FS** .326	**Curveball** → Chase down & away his breaking there: 52% whiff · .318 xwOBAcon · n=77	.297 2nd ST .302	avoid **FC** .319
Behind 1-0, 2-0, 2-1, 3-1	**Curveball** → Middle away his breaking there: 14% whiff · .098 xwOBAcon · n=15	.298 2nd ST .299	avoid **FS** .328	**Curveball** → Down & away his breaking there: 25% whiff · .376 xwOBAcon · n=22	.281 2nd ST .286	avoid **SI** .312
Two-strike 0-2, 1-2, 2-2, 3-2	**Curveball** → Down & away his breaking there: 20% whiff · .760 xwOBAcon · n=17	.319 2nd FC .326	avoid **FS** .341	**Curveball** → Chase down & away his breaking there: 52% whiff · .318 xwOBAcon · n=77	.305 2nd ST .312	avoid **FC** .327

COUNTS Count tendencies — swings at 24% of first pitches (league 32%); chases 34% with two strikes (league 41%)

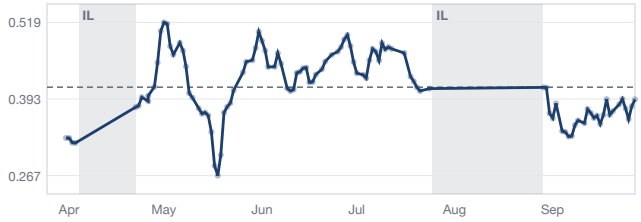
Small numbers = percentage-point difference from league in that count. Chase/whiff tinted vs league (red = better for the hitter); xwOBA on contact tinted vs league. Grey = n < 25 pitches.

BY COUNT	0-0	1-0	2-0	3-0	0-1	1-1	2-1	3-1	0-2	1-2	2-2	3-2
Pitches	483	213	104	40	223	187	124	53	94	161	150	97
Swing %	24 -8	25 -17	34 -5	8 +1	37 -12	51 -4	60 +3	32 -19	40 -11	57 -1	57 -7	69 -1
Chase %	9 -9	9 -15	20 -0	4 +1	17 -13	18 -16	30 -3	7 -19	26 -10	32 -9	37 -8	44 -2
Whiff / swing	20 -4	11 -12	20 +0	33 +20	22 -4	21 -3	19 -2	24 +6	24 -2	23 -1	13 -8	13 -3
xwOBA on contact	.350	.425	.377	.837	.530	.489	.538	.499	.552	.331	.396	.391

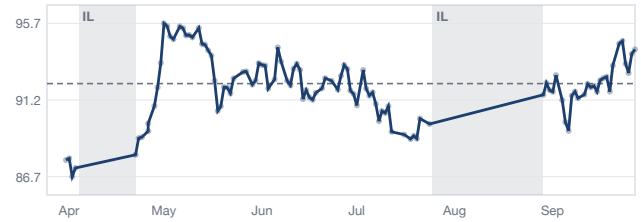
TRENDS Trends — steady relative to his season line

15-game rolling (min 5 games); dashed = season. ⚑ = latest window differs by ≥.045 xwOBA, 2 mph EV or 5 pts chase. Grey = IL: Apr 4–Apr 22 (Right calf strain); Jul 25–Aug 29 (Left calf strain).

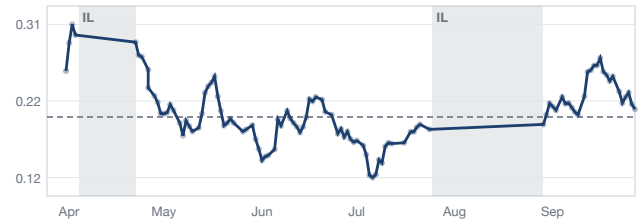
xwOBA — 15-game rolling



Avg exit velo — 15-game rolling



Chase rate — 15-game rolling



SPLITS Platoon — 81-pt xwOBA edge vs RHP

Statcast PAs. xwOBA tint vs league .315 (red = better for the hitter). Grey: < 60 PA.

SPLIT	PA	AVG	WOBA	XWOBA	K%	BB%	HR	BARREL	CHASE
vs RHP	300	.273	.405	.441	13.7%	16.3%	21	16.0%	18%
vs LHP	165	.268	.344	.360	14.5%	8.5%	6	10.4%	24%

COMPS Comps — closest offensive profile: Ben Rice

Nearest qualified hitters on barrel%, EV90, contact, chase, zone swing, pull-air, GB%, launch angle, whiff by pitch group, BB% and K% (standardized, weighted).

Ben Rice NYY Hit 50 Pwr 65 — 43% similar
LHB · 14.3% barrel · EV90 105.5 · 76% contact · 24% chase · xwOBA .378

Seiya Suzuki CHC Hit 50 Pwr 60 — 42% similar
RHB · 10.7% barrel · EV90 106.0 · 79% contact · 22% chase · xwOBA .340

Curtis Mead BOS Hit 60 Pwr 60 — 42% similar
RHB · 10.8% barrel · EV90 105.1 · 84% contact · 25% chase · xwOBA .358

Grades. z-score composites → percentile within hitters with ≥1,000 pitches seen → 50 + 10·Φ⁻¹(p), clipped 20–80, shown to the nearest 5. Hit = contact%, xBA, K%, whiff vs FB/BRK. Power = barrel%, EV90, max EV, ISO, hard-hit%. Discipline = chase%, zone-swing minus chase, BB%. Pull-air = pulled fly balls/liners share. Speed = FanGraphs Spd (sprint speed is not in this dataset). vs-pitch grades = hitter RV/100 by pitch group. **Models.** attack plan = situational pitch-type model scored against a league-average arsenal from each hand (this hitter's priors), then the location model's best zone for that pitch; alignment = shift-legal greedy optimizer over his balls in play with a catch-probability fielding model, gain reported 2-fold cross-validated (fit on half his BIP, scored on the other half). Predicted xwOBA gaps are small — the cited zone stats are his actual results. **Caveats.** single season, regular season only; zone cells with small samples greyed; xwOBA ignores park; alignment model is approximate (no runner/game state).